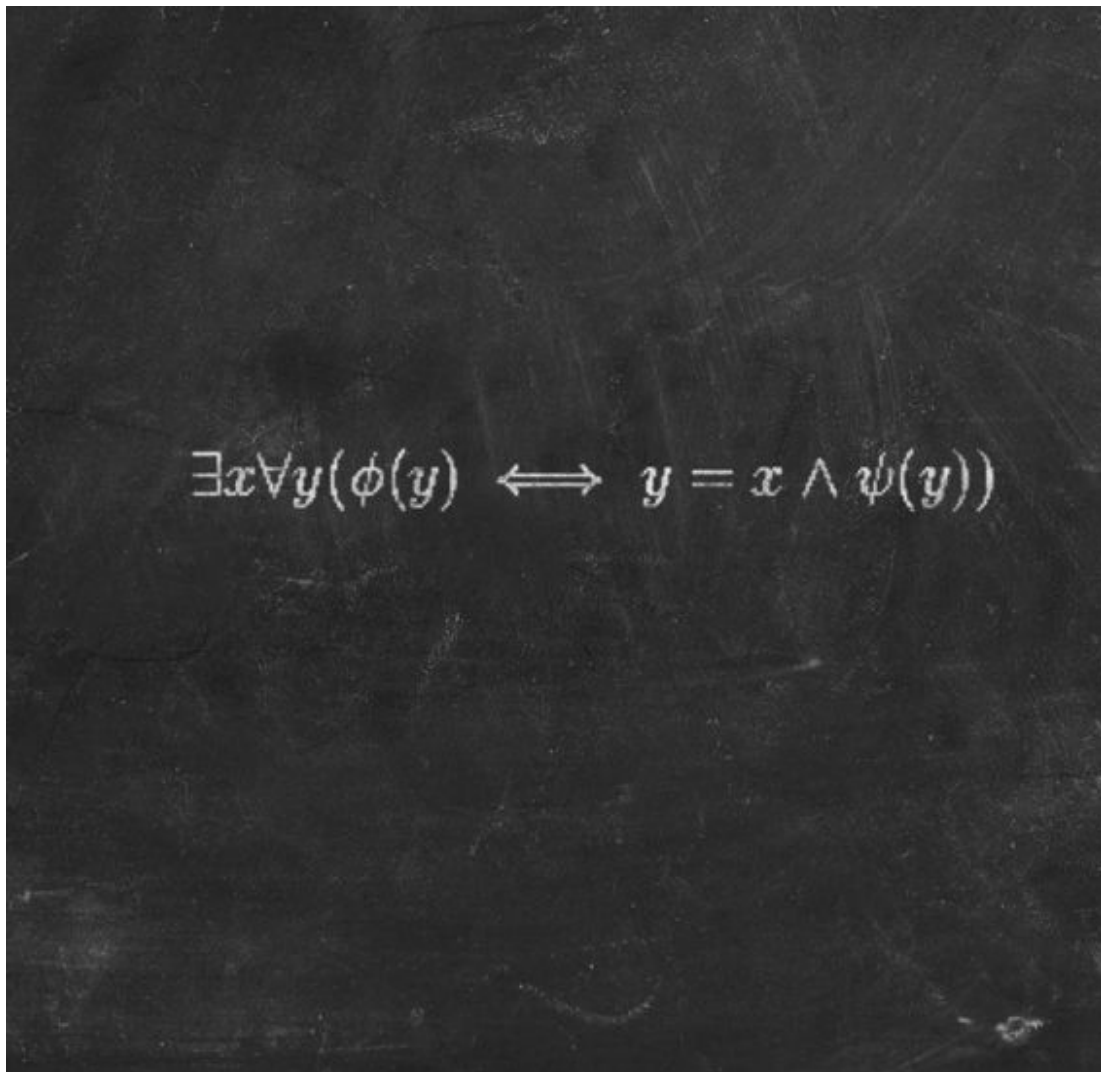


Analytic philosophy



Russell came from the tradition of empiricism and, along with his colleague G.E. Moore, led the British movement in philosophy away from the idealism that had dominated the 19th century. Having demonstrated that mathematics and logic were inseparably connected in the *Principia* (see [Principia Mathematics](#)), Russell set out to show that logic should be the basis for philosophical enquiry: because it consists of objective, universal truths, logic is a firmer foundation for our knowledge of the world than the speculation offered by epistemology. Applying techniques of logical analysis to statements about our knowledge enables an objective evaluation of them, an approach to philosophical enquiry that became known as

analytic philosophy. In order to analyse philosophical statements logically, they first have to be presented in a logical form, similar to the propositions of mathematics, using the formal grammar and signs and symbols of logic. A philosophical argument can then be shown as valid or invalid using the rules of logic, in much the same way as a mathematical proof.